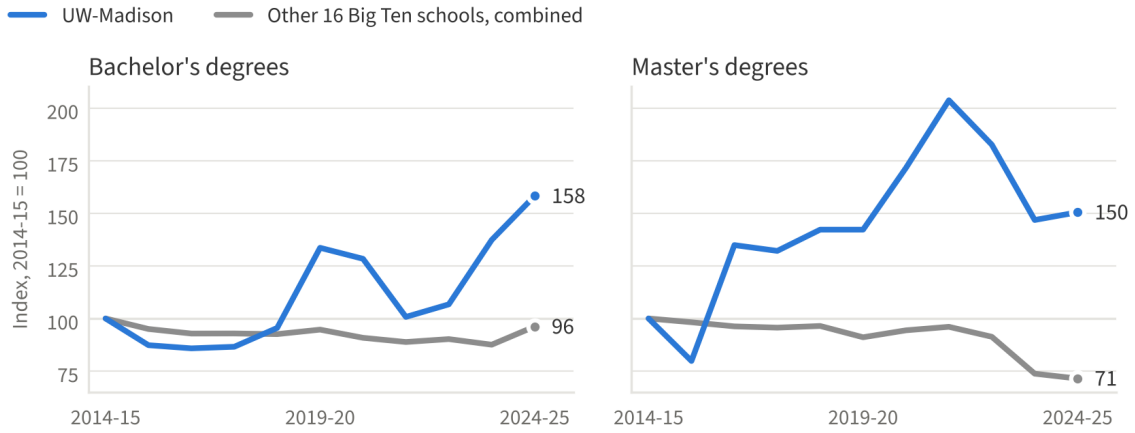
The UW–Madison School of Education in public data: a first look

An addendum to Gies Program Health · Om Hitesh Vyas · November 2026 · github.com/omvyas77/program-health · Not affiliated with or endorsed by UW–Madison

Education degrees grew at UW–Madison while they fell across the Big Ten

Comparing three-year averages, 2014-15 to 2016-17 against 2022-23 to 2024-25, UW–Madison's education bachelor's degrees rose +47% (122 to 180 a year) and its education master's degrees rose +52% (114 to 174). Over the same windows the other 16 schools combined fell −5% at the bachelor's level and −20% at the master's level. UW–Madison's master's growth is the largest of the 18, and only 4 of the other 17 grew at all. Doctoral degrees held roughly level (58 to 56 a year).



Education is CIP 13, first majors only. Penn State is left out of the combined line because its 2019-20 and 2020-21 files are excluded. 2024-25 is a provisional IPEDS release. Source: IPEDS completions, C2015_A to C2025_A.

New programs drove the bachelor's growth; two fields drove the master's

Three-year bachelor's totals rose by 173. 85 of them (49%) are in CIP 13.09, Social and Philosophical Foundations of Education, which first passes 10 bachelor's degrees in 2018-19, reached 38 in 2024-25, and matches the Educational Policy Studies BS. Subject-area teacher education (13.13, including art and physical education) added 48 and elementary teacher education (13.12) added 44, while special education was about flat (−4). At the master's level, curriculum and instruction went from 120 to 262 and special education from 19 to 79, while educational administration went from 185 to 168. Master's degrees peaked at 222 in 2021-22 and were 164 in 2024-25, so the recent direction matters more than the ten-year one.

Education is only about half of the degrees in the School's fields

IPEDS reports by field, not by school, so I mapped the CIP codes the School's ten departments appear to confer, with a confidence for each code. In 2024-25 education accounted for 426 of 984 mapped degrees (43%), kinesiology and health 289, psychology and counseling 161, and the arts 108. Medium-confidence codes contribute 165 of those; counting only high-confidence codes, education is 52%. In either count the health, psychology, and arts fields make up about half of the mapped degrees. These are a starting point, not School totals.

What I would check first with internal access

1. Reconcile the map against RADAR's Trends in Degrees, department by department, settle the medium-confidence codes, and confirm that every department's degrees were attributed to the School in every year shown. 2. Find which programs and delivery modes drove the 2021-22 master's peak and the decline since. 3. Add what public data can't show: retention and time to degree by entry program, licensure and post-graduation outcomes, scholarship awards against yield, and seat fill for high-demand courses.

Limits: first majors only; certificates left out; 2024-25 is a provisional IPEDS release; Penn State is left out of the combined peer line. Every number is computed by brief/soe_note.py from data/marts, and the tables with their SQL are in docs/findings.md (F1 to F4).